

Use the AI Equity Lens



AI can create benefits and costs at the same time. Start with what is known, name what is uncertain, and ask who has power.

PROJECT: AI EQUITY LENS

First, sort what you hear or read

☐ **FACT**

Something that can be checked with reliable evidence.

☐ **CLAIM**

A statement that needs evidence before we accept it.

☐ **VALUE**

An idea about what matters, what is fair, or what should happen.

☐ **PREDICTION**

A reasoned statement about what may happen - not a fact about the future.

☐ **UNKNOWN**

Information that is missing, uncertain, or disputed.

Then follow the six-question thread

1**Who benefits?****2****Who might be harmed or excluded?****3****Who controls it or can challenge it?****4****Whose voice or experience is missing?****5****Who should help decide what happens next?****6****What evidence could change your view?****OUR NEXT QUESTION** _____

AI Equity Dilemma Cards



Choose one card. Notice a real opportunity and a real risk. Ask what evidence, consent, or rule could change the outcome.

USE WITH: AI EQUITY LENS

CARD 1 - ACCESS

TRANSLATION NOW

An AI translator lets a newcomer join a class discussion right away. It sometimes misses meaning or tone.

WHO BENEFITS?

WHO MIGHT BE HARMED OR EXCLUDED?

WHO HAS POWER OR CAN CHALLENGE IT?

WHAT EVIDENCE OR RULE COULD MAKE THIS MORE EQUITABLE?

CARD 2 - DISCRIMINATION

FACE MATCH

A facial-recognition system is less accurate for some groups. A school is considering it for building entry.

WHO BENEFITS?

WHO MIGHT BE HARMED OR EXCLUDED?

WHO HAS POWER OR CAN CHALLENGE IT?

WHAT EVIDENCE OR RULE COULD MAKE THIS MORE EQUITABLE?

AI Equity Dilemma Cards



Choose one card. Notice a real opportunity and a real risk. Ask what evidence, consent, or rule could change the outcome.

USE WITH: AI EQUITY LENS

CARD 3 - ACCESS + WEALTH

PAID TUTOR

An AI tutor gives useful feedback. Families who pay get a stronger version with more help.

WHO BENEFITS?

WHO MIGHT BE HARMED OR EXCLUDED?

WHO HAS POWER OR CAN CHALLENGE IT?

WHAT EVIDENCE OR RULE COULD MAKE THIS MORE EQUITABLE?

CARD 4 - ENVIRONMENT

DATA CENTRE

A data centre brings jobs and services. It also needs electricity, equipment, land and cooling.

WHO BENEFITS?

WHO MIGHT BE HARMED OR EXCLUDED?

WHO HAS POWER OR CAN CHALLENGE IT?

WHAT EVIDENCE OR RULE COULD MAKE THIS MORE EQUITABLE?

AI Equity Dilemma Cards



Choose one card. Notice a real opportunity and a real risk. Ask what evidence, consent, or rule could change the outcome.

USE WITH: AI EQUITY LENS

CARD 5 - PRIVACY + POWER

STUDENT SUPPORT

A system watches behaviour to predict who may need support. Students cannot see or challenge its score.

WHO BENEFITS?

WHO MIGHT BE HARMED OR EXCLUDED?

WHO HAS POWER OR CAN CHALLENGE IT?

WHAT EVIDENCE OR RULE COULD MAKE THIS MORE EQUITABLE?

CARD 6 - CONSENT

CULTURAL KNOWLEDGE

Community-held cultural knowledge appears in an AI answer. The community was not asked about this use.

WHO BENEFITS?

WHO MIGHT BE HARMED OR EXCLUDED?

WHO HAS POWER OR CAN CHALLENGE IT?

WHAT EVIDENCE OR RULE COULD MAKE THIS MORE EQUITABLE?

AI Equity Dilemma Cards



Choose one card. Notice a real opportunity and a real risk. Ask what evidence, consent, or rule could change the outcome.

USE WITH: AI EQUITY LENS

CARD 7 - WORK + WEALTH

WORK CHANGES

AI removes repetitive work and raises production. The company decides how the savings and benefits are shared.

WHO BENEFITS?

WHO MIGHT BE HARMED OR EXCLUDED?

WHO HAS POWER OR CAN CHALLENGE IT?

WHAT EVIDENCE OR RULE COULD MAKE THIS MORE EQUITABLE?

CARD 8 - DEMOCRACY

CONVINCING FAKE

A realistic video of a candidate spreads before an election. The original source cannot be confirmed.

WHO BENEFITS?

WHO MIGHT BE HARMED OR EXCLUDED?

WHO HAS POWER OR CAN CHALLENGE IT?

WHAT EVIDENCE OR RULE COULD MAKE THIS MORE EQUITABLE?

AI Rules Council: Who Needs a Seat?



Protect a real benefit. Prevent a serious harm. Include people who are affected, especially when they have less power.

USE WITH: AI RULES COUNCIL

Choose up to three roles for your group to consider closely. A council may need more voices than one group can hold.

☐ STUDENTS

How will learning, access, privacy, or safety change?

☐ FAMILIES

What support, information, or consent may be needed?

☐ WORKERS

How will work, pay, control, or responsibility change?

☐ BUSINESSES

What can the system do, and who pays for it?

☐ SCIENTISTS

What does the evidence show, and what is uncertain?

☐ DISABILITY ADVOCATES

Does it remove barriers or create new ones?

☐ INDIGENOUS GOVERNMENTS

What authority, rights, consent, and data rules apply?

☐ ENVIRONMENTAL ADVOCATES

Where do energy, water, land, materials, and waste matter?

☐ GOVERNMENT

Which rights, rules, services, and checks are required?

☐ FUTURE GENERATIONS

Which long-term effects could outlast today's benefits?

WHO IS NOT IN THE ROOM BUT WILL STILL BE AFFECTED?



Build a Checkable AI Rule

A strong rule protects a useful benefit, limits a serious harm, and tells people how to challenge a decision.

USE WITH: AI RULES COUNCIL

THEN: POWER + CHECKS

1 BENEFIT TO PROTECT

What useful access, service, or possibility should remain?

2 HARM TO PREVENT

Which unfair cost, exclusion, or rights risk must be limited?

3 RIGHT TO CHALLENGE

How can an affected person get an explanation, correction, or appeal?

4 CHECK + REPORT

What evidence will be reviewed, by whom, and when?

Write the rule so someone can check whether it was followed

The system may _____ only if

_____.

People affected can _____ will

check and report _____ by _____.

Power + Checks: Test the Rule



A rule is not enough by itself. Build a route that people can actually use when an AI decision affects them.

USE WITH: POWER + CHECKS

1

NOTICE

How will an affected person know AI was used?

2

HUMAN EXPLANATION

Who can explain the decision in clear language?

3

SAFE APPEAL

How can the person challenge it without added risk or cost?

4

CORRECTION

Who can change wrong information or reverse a decision?

5

LATER FAIRNESS CHECK

Who checks patterns over time, and when are results reported?

STRESS TEST THE ROUTE

Could someone with less money, less time, less language access, or less power still use every step safely? What must change?

NAME THE KIND OF FUTURE CLAIM

☐ CURRENT

Already used now.

☐ EMERGING

Being tested; evidence is developing.

☐ PREDICTION

A reasoned claim about what may happen.

☐ HYPOTHETICAL

A possibility used to test values and rules.

Teacher Evidence Shelf



Open the source matched to the dilemma. Use what the evidence supports; name uncertainty and disagreement honestly.

CARDS 1 + 3

**Accessibility Standards
Canada - equitable AI**



accessible.canada.ca

CARDS 2 + 5

**Canadian Human Rights
Commission - AI bias**



chrc-ccdp.gc.ca

CARDS 1 + 5

**Privacy Commissioner -
Canadian AI principles**



priv.gc.ca

CARD 6

**FNIGC - First Nations
principles of OCAP**



fnigc.ca

CARD 8

**Elections Canada - AI and
inaccurate information**



elections.ca

CARD 4

**International Energy
Agency - Energy and AI**



iea.org

CARD 7

OECD - AI and work



oecd.org

ALL CARDS

UNESCO - Ethics of AI



unesco.org



Teacher Quick Start: AI Equity

Choose one dilemma. Sort the evidence, apply the lens, then revise or build a rule. No AI account, device, or student data is needed.

Hub screen to printable map

AI EQUITY LENS

Page 1

Project the screen; use the sorter and six questions as a whole-class lens.

AI EQUITY LENS

Pages 2-5

Print only the dilemma page or cards you choose; one copy per group.

AI RULES COUNCIL

Page 6

Choose affected voices and add someone missing from the room.

AI RULES COUNCIL

Page 7

Protect one benefit, prevent one harm, and write a checkable rule.

POWER + CHECKS

Page 8

Test notice, explanation, appeal, correction, and later fairness checks.

TEACHER ONLY

Page 9

Open the source matched to the dilemma before discussion.

MODEL - ABOUT 60 SECONDS

Read Card 1: 'Fast participation is a benefit. An error in a safety message is a cost. I need to know the stakes, accuracy, and who can correct it.'

COLLECT / NOTICE

Listen for a protected benefit, a named cost, missing evidence, an affected voice, and a rule with a real check. A written product is optional.

CARE

Use fictional scenarios. Do not enter student information into AI. Do not test sacred, restricted, or community-held knowledge; impersonate an Indigenous voice; or ask students to disclose disability, income, or family access.

DEBRIEF

What evidence changed your view? Who gains a real benefit? Who carries a cost? Who can say no, appeal, correct, or stop the system?